

that Lindbergh received on successful completion of his New York-to-Paris flight on May 21 (see pages 118–19). But the extraordinary scale of the popular response to the young American's flight, both in Europe and on his return to the United States, has never been adequately explained. It was a considerable feat by any measure to have flown solo across the Atlantic, yet only two weeks later Clarence Chamberlin and Charles Levine flew from New York to within 100 miles (160km) of Berlin in a Wright-Bellanca (incidentally the airplane Lindbergh had originally wanted to fly), beating Lindbergh both for distance and endurance. They made the headlines, but only for a few days. It was Lindbergh who was caught in the exhilarating but eventually destructive embrace of celebrity.

The "Lindbergh effect"

The only clear historical significance of Lindbergh's flight was as the turning point at which the United States took its place as the leader in world aviation for the first time since the Wright brothers. The "Lindbergh effect" would have given a mighty boost to America's struggling air transportation and airplane-making businesses even without the new hero's enthusiastic active commitment to promoting aviation. In the event, Lindbergh followed his transatlantic flight with a Guggenheim-sponsored tour of every state of the Union, which led directly to airport building throughout the US. In the following years he promoted passenger airlines, letting TAT (Transcontinental Air Transport, later TWA) advertise itself as the "Lindbergh Line," and carrying out wide-ranging route-survey and publicity flights on behalf of Juan Trippe and Pan Am.

Inevitably Lindbergh's Atlantic crossing inspired a new wave of transoceanic and transcontinental flights, keeping the press supplied with sensational copy and creating a new generation of pilot-celebrities. Each nation had to have its own heroes to compete with Lindbergh. France, for example, had Dieudonné Costes. In 1927 he crossed the South Atlantic, flew down the eastern seaboard of South America, and back up the Pacific coast as far as Washington state; and in 1930, with Maurice Bellonte, he made the first direct nonstop flight from Paris to New York in the Breguet 19 Point d'Interrogation. Italians worshipped Francesco De Pinedo, a naval officer who flew across the Atlantic in one Savoia-Marchetti flying boat, crashed it, and flew back in another. In 1930, Amy Johnson, a former stenographer from Hull, England, became the darling of the press after flying solo from England to Australia in a de Havilland Moth. Amelia Earhart, fulfilling America's need for a female Lindbergh, was lauded in 1928 as the first woman to fly across the Atlantic, although this was in a Fokker trimotor piloted by Wilmer Stultz. Four

LONG-DISTANCE AIRCRAFT

THE DEGREE OF PUBLIC attention focused on long-distance flights between the wars often corresponded to the degree of danger in aircraft that often had only primitive navigational equipment. Given the problem of engine reliability, multiengine aircraft were often preferred, as were seaplanes or flying boats. In the aftermath of WWI, most record-setting long-distance flights were made in converted military aircraft. A huge gulf separated their performance from that of 1930s long-distance racing aircraft such as the Lockheed Vega and D.H.88 Comet. And no aircraft could match the range of an airship like the *Graf Zeppelin*.

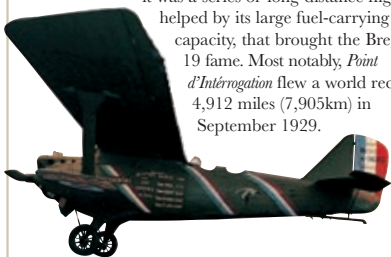
ROUSING RECEPTION

Alan Cobham prepares to land his D.H.50J by the Houses of Parliament, London, on October 1, 1926, after successfully completing a round-trip to Australia.



Breguet XIX "Point d'Interrogation"

Introduced in 1922, more Breguet 19s were built than any other military aircraft between the wars. However it was a series of long-distance flights, helped by its large fuel-carrying capacity, that brought the Breguet 19 fame. Most notably, *Point d'Interrogation* flew a world record 4,912 miles (7,905km) in September 1929.



ENGINE 650hp Hispano-Suiza 12Lb

WINGSPAN 48ft 8in (14.8m) **LENGTH** 31ft 3in (9.5m)

TOP SPEED Unknown **CREW** 2

PASSENGERS None

Curtiss NC-4

On May 31, 1919, a Curtiss NC-4, flown by Lt.-Commander Read, became the first plane to fly across the Atlantic.

One of three specially designed Curtiss flying boats commissioned by the US Navy, the NC-4 was the only one to complete the epic 3,925 mile (6,319km) flight, crossing from New York to Plymouth in stages, via Halifax, Nova Scotia, the Azores, and Lisbon.



ENGINE 4 x 400hp Liberty 12A

WINGSPAN 126ft (38.4m) **LENGTH** 68ft 3in (20.8m)

TOP SPEED 85mph (137kph) **CREW** 5

ARMAMENT Provision for 8 machine guns but none carried

de Havilland D.H.88 Comet (Racer)

To mark the centenary of the State of Victoria, Australia, in 1934, an England-to-Australia air race was planned. De Havilland designed an advanced two-seat racer specifically for the event and three were entered for the MacRobertson Mildenhall-to-Melbourne Air Race. The winning Comet *Grosvenor House* won in just under 71 hours.

Three fuel tanks in fuselage, ahead of cockpit



ENGINE 2 x 230hp de Havilland Gipsy Six R

WINGSPAN 44ft (13.4m) **LENGTH** 29ft (8.8m)

TOP SPEED 237mph (381kph) **CREW** 2

PASSENGERS None

de Havilland D.H.60G Gipsy Moth

ENGINE 100hp de Havilland Gipsy I 4-cylinder water-cooled inline

WINGSPAN 29ft 8in (9.1m) **LENGTH** 23ft 11in (7.3m)

TOP SPEED 102mph (164kph) **CREW** 2

PASSENGERS None

In the D.H.60 Moth, which first flew in 1925, de Havilland created the ideal, multipurpose light airplane. Nearly 600 were built before production ceased in 1934, of which the most successful version was the D.H.60G which not only won the 1928 King's Cup air race, but also completed many long-distance flights.

